



The NYC Volunteer Fire Department Project for MGMT 603 Nonprofit Accounting and Financial Management

A Signature Term Experiential Learning Project

A Step-by-Step Guide

Revised 3/26/26



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Introduction: Overview of the NYC Volunteer Fire Department Project

In this course, we will examine the volunteer fire departments that serve mainly New York City's coastal and geographically isolated communities. These volunteer fire departments must balance public safety responsibilities with financial sustainability. All of them are nonprofit organizations that serve as instructive experiential learning environments. These departments face accounting and financial management issues, such as replacing major emergency equipment, which can cost hundreds of thousands of dollars and is typically funded through grants, fundraising, and financing.

In this project, students will build a six-year financial dataset covering all NYC volunteer firehouse nonprofits and analyze their financial sustainability using Excel. Students will also visit a local firehouse to understand its operations and equipment needs, which will inform their analysis. Students will simulate funding scenarios and assess the risk and financial readiness of these organizations to make significant equipment and other purchases.

History of New York City Volunteer Fire Departments

Per The Volunteer Firemen's Association of the City of New York (2025) (VFACNY), volunteer fire departments began to play an increasingly important role in the fire service in New York City in the late 1800s. At that time, the city's volunteer fire departments were facing a number of challenges, including inadequate funding, poor equipment, and a lack of training opportunities. In response, a group of volunteer firefighters formed the VFACNY in order to advocate for the needs of volunteer fire departments and to provide support and resources to its members.

The VFACNY was established to advocate for the rights and interests of volunteer firefighters, and to provide them with training, equipment and other resources. The organization's early leaders worked to improve the conditions and status of volunteer firefighters in New York City.

Over the years, the VFACNY has played a key role in advocating for better working conditions, and benefits for volunteer firefighters. It has also worked to improve the quality and availability of training for volunteer firefighters and to increase funding for volunteer fire departments.

In addition to advocating for the interests of volunteer fire departments, the VFACNY has also played an important role in promoting the history and tradition of the fire service in New York City. The organization has organized events and ceremonies to commemorate the contributions of volunteer firefighters, and has worked to preserve the history and heritage of the fire service in the city. Throughout its history, the VFACNY has played an important role in supporting volunteer firefighters in New York City, and it continues to be a vital organization for the thousands of men and women who volunteer their time and expertise to protect their communities from the threat of fire. They work alongside career firefighters and provide vital services to residents and visitors.

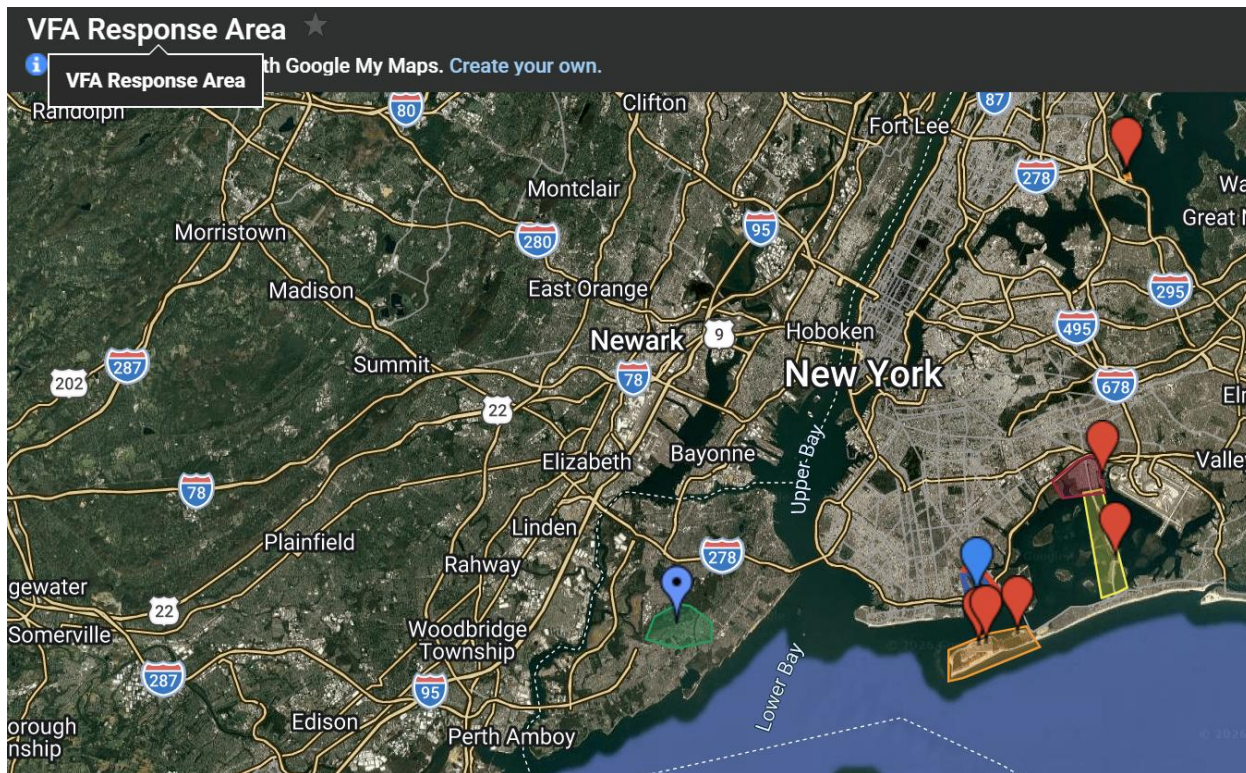
Despite these changes, the VFACNY and its departments play an important part of the fire service in New York City. Today, there are 8 volunteer fire departments across the city that work alongside the New York City Fire Department (FDNY), which is one of the largest fire departments in the world, staffed by over 11,000 career firefighters. The eight fire departments are: Broad Channel VFD & Ambulance Corp., Edgewater Park Volunteer Hose Company No. 1, Gerritsen Beach Volunteer Fire Department, Point

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Breeze Volunteer Fire Department, Richmond Engine Company #1, Rockaway Point Volunteer Fire Department, Roxbury Volunteer Fire Department, and West Hamilton Beach Volunteer Fire Department. These volunteer departments provide vital services to residents and visitors, and are staffed by men and women who are dedicated to protecting their communities from the threat of fire and other emergencies.

Today, the VFACNY continues to play an important role in supporting and representing the interests of volunteer fire departments in New York City. It continues to work closely with the FDNY and other organizations to ensure that volunteer departments have the resources they need to protect the communities they serve.

The locations of these volunteer fire departments are marked on the following map.



NYC Volunteer Fire Departments Offer an Experience to Connect Theory to Practice

Many accounting and finance students report difficulty connecting abstract financial theories to real-world decision-making, particularly in organizations that do not operate for profit. Traditional coursework often relies on short case studies that offer limited insight into how organizations function in practice. Compared to other fields (e.g., education, healthcare, and the physical sciences), accounting and finance programs offer relatively few opportunities for immersive, community-based experiences in both undergraduate and graduate settings (Foy et al., 2024; Foy et al., 2025). This gap is especially evident when students attempt to understand how financial management operates within mission-driven organizations such as volunteer fire departments.

This project addresses that gap by placing students directly in the context of New York City volunteer fire departments, where financial decisions are closely tied to public safety, community trust, and resource constraints. Unlike traditional business environments, volunteer fire departments rely on a

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combination of grants, donations, fundraising efforts, and limited public funding to sustain operations. Through this immersive, semester-long venue-based experiential learning project, students engage with a real organizations, observing how financial decisions are made, how funding priorities are established, and how operational needs (e.g., equipment, training, facilities) are balanced against financial realities.

Rather than analyzing a static case, students develop an evolving understanding of how accounting and financial management issues function in a high-stakes, community-centered environment. We explore questions such as: How does a fire department fund a new apparatus? What trade-offs are made between equipment upgrades and community outreach? How do financial constraints influence emergency readiness? This sustained engagement allows students to connect theoretical concepts, such as budgeting, capital financing, and cost analysis, to real-world implications that directly impact public safety.

By the end of the project, students are expected to develop a deeper, more practical understanding of how financial principles apply in nonprofit and public service contexts. In addition, the experience supports the development of transferable, employer-valued skills such as communication, critical thinking, adaptability, and professional judgment, particularly in environments where financial decisions carry significant social consequences.

The instructions in this document are designed to guide students in linking textbook concepts to real-world observations and analysis within their local communities. This project encourages students to view accounting and finance not simply as technical disciplines, but as essential tools for supporting organizations that serve and protect the public. This manual is intentionally flexible and may be refined as needed. Students and instructors are encouraged to provide feedback and identify opportunities for clarification or enhancement as the project evolves.

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Project Implementation

Throughout the semester, students will study accounting and financial management concepts through assigned readings and course materials. This project complements those materials by providing a structured opportunity to apply theory in a real business context.

The project consists of five deliverables spaced across the semester. Students will collect nonprofit tax return data on all NYC volunteer fire departments and analyze them, identify and visit a local fire department to familiarize themselves with fire department apparatus, analyze risk and funding scenarios, prepare a presentation on findings, and reflect on how the experience developed employer-desired competencies.

While all deliverables are graded individually, collaboration by sharing experiences with fellow classmates is highly encouraged. This structure reflects real workplace environments, where individuals are evaluated on both independent performance and share experiences with others.

A process flowchart on the following page summarizes the deliverable sequence, submission requirements, and grading criteria. The remainder of this document provides detailed instructions, templates, and grading rubrics. Reviewing the templates early is strongly recommended.

Research Study Information

Even though this project is required to fulfill course objectives, I intend to analyze the outcomes of the deliverables to contribute to an educational research study. At the end of the project, I may send all students an email invitation to take a survey related to our research asking you to consent to use outcomes

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from the project. If you agree, we will de-identify all student work. This means identifying information (example: IP addresses, student ID) is initially collected but is later removed. At the end of the project, upon review of outcomes, I may send you a separate email asking you written permission to disclose certain outcomes, such as pictures taken during the project. All names will be anonymized. Any photograph used will be used for research purposes, such as presentations at conferences or publication. Names will be anonymized. The principal investigator and the co-investigators will be the only parties with access. Outcomes will be stored in a password protected cloud-based server.

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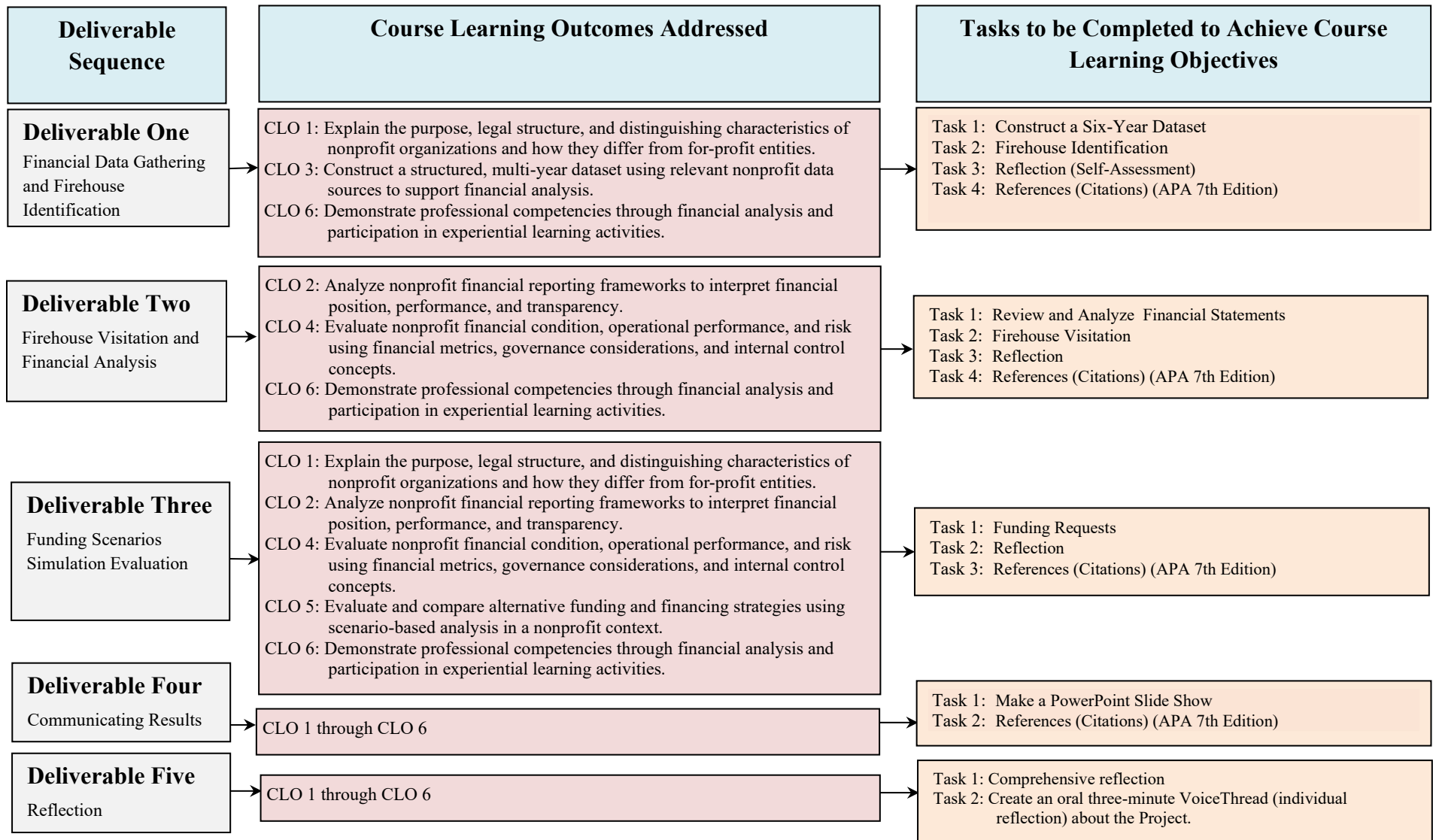
Final Thoughts

In addition to the instructions set forth in the Step-by-Step Guide, to enhance your understanding of the business entity and its environment, students should use all resources available to them, including to, but not limited to the library (specifically the business librarian), Internet, professional opinions and interpretations, company published information, brokerage house information, etc. Students should think about creative ways to extract and understand information. This instruction guide will direct you, but it **will not** hold your hand during the semester. It is your project to learn from.

Good luck with this experiential learning project and let it enrich your understanding of accounting and corporate finance!

Dr. Joseph Foy, CPA
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Deliverables Process Flowchart



Purpose of the NYC Volunteer Fire Department Project

The purpose of the NYC Volunteer Fire Department Project is to connect the abstract theories a student learns in a typical issues in nonprofit accounting and/or financial management course, use a venue-based (a place outside of the classroom) local fire house as a concrete experience, engage in active experimentation (applying theory), and reflect on the experiences. The project requires that students identify and visit an independent local firehouse and attempt to engage a firefighter to conduct a short tour of a firehouse and its operations. Inform the firefighter that you are studying nonprofit accounting and financial management in school, and you have been tasked to study the financial aspects of a small nonprofit organization, which requires a basic understanding of how a firehouse operates. The aim is for students to gain a more comprehensive understanding of accounting and finance issues related to nonprofit organizations, and observing and understanding a local volunteer firehouse serves as a great example. Although many government-run firehouses are not nonprofit organizations, the equipment and apparatus they use are similar and can be easily substituted for a volunteer firehouse.

Another purpose of this project is to help all students further develop employer-desired competencies and be able to tell a visual and oral story to potential employers about how they learned nonprofit accounting and financial management theories and examples of their application.

Project Learning Objectives

1. Integrate employer-desired competencies to develop highly valued employer-desired skills.
2. Construct and analyze a comprehensive financial profile of a nonprofit organization using real-world data and field-based observations.
3. Analyze real nonprofit financial data and interpret nonprofit operations from a nonprofit accounting and financial management perspective.
4. Defend evidence-based financial recommendations under realistic operational constraints in a nonprofit context.
5. Communicate financial insights and reflect on experiential learning to demonstrate professional judgment, analytical thinking, and applied competency development.

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Deliverables

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Deliverable One: Financial Data Gathering and Firehouse Identification

Course Learning Outcomes Addressed

CLO 1: Explain the purpose, legal structure, and distinguishing characteristics of nonprofit organizations.

CLO 3: Construct a structured, multi-year dataset using relevant nonprofit data sources to support financial analysis.

CLO 6: Demonstrate professional competencies through financial analysis and participation in experiential learning activities.

Deliverable One Project Learning Outcomes:

1. Integrate employer-desired competencies to develop highly valued employer-desired skills.
2. Construct and analyze a comprehensive financial profile of a nonprofit organization using real-world data and field-based observations.

Deliverable One is designed to help students understand accounting and finance theories by connecting them to a real-life. Students are learning how to learn, using concrete examples to improve their understanding.

Virtual option: For those with an accommodation letter who cannot physically visit a local firehouse, there is a virtual option to complete this task. Students with accessibility limitations should rely on Google Maps, Yelp, a local firehouse's website, or other means such as online reviews, images, and interview people who may have a close connection to the local firehouse chosen.

Employer-Desired Competencies

Additionally, this assignment is designed to help you develop highly valued, employer-desired competencies across all industries. This list below is compiled by [Deloitte's Workforce of the Future Institute](#). They include:

1. **Empathy:** Understanding another person's thoughts and feelings from their point of view, rather than one's own.
2. **Adaptability:** The ability to adjust to new conditions.

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3. **Emotional Intelligence:** The ability to manage both one's own emotions and understand the emotions of people around oneself.
4. **Problem-Solving:** The ability to go through a process of finding solutions to difficult or complex issues.
5. **Critical Thinking:** The ability to identify a problem and logically think through it to find a solution.
6. **Logical Reasoning:** The ability to distinguish facts from mere opinions. The ability to understand that when important information is missing, it is often better to suspend judgment than to jump to conclusions.
7. **Curiosity:** The ability to be eager to know or learn something.
8. **Resilience:** The ability to recover quickly from difficulties or making mistakes.
9. **Communication (Written and Verbal):** The ability to write notes and verbally communicate. The ability to pay more attention to important details when it may be needed to make a decision.

By completing this deliverable, you're not just learning about nonprofit accounting and financial management. You are building a foundation of career-ready skills that will help you succeed in any other future professional setting.

D1 Tasks:

For this deliverable, students must complete the tasks below. It is important that students become familiar with and follow the D1 grading rubric for each task.

Task D1.1: Construct a Six-Year Dataset and Firehouse Identification

Your task is to construct a six-year dataset for all NYC volunteer firehouse nonprofits, and

D1.1 Task Requirements:

Address the requirements by using the [D1 Template](#) in the [Templates Section](#) of this document.

1. Go to the [Volunteer Fireman's Association of the City of New York](#) website and identify all volunteer firehouses in NYC.
2. Use the [Tax Exempt Organization Search Tool](#) and locate copies of the tax returns filed by the Volunteer Fire Departments.
3. Create an Excel Spreadsheet of all the names and available years of the entities.
4. Extract selected financial data.
5. Give a summary description of the financial data you collected. What is the initial financial story about the state of volunteer departments in NYC?

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6. Describe what financial aspects of the business you observed or understood. In other words, what did you do when you were there (e.g., walking through the space, watching processes, interacting with people).
7. Describe what your senses picked up (sounds, smells, movement, pace, atmosphere).

Students should collect data from sources such as IRS Form 990 filings, ProPublica, Candid (GuideStar), NY State charity filings, Nonprofit websites, Local news or fundraising reports, etc.

[*Click here to go to the Deliverable One Grading Rubrics*](#)

Task D1.2 Firehouse Identification

Your task is to identify a primary target firehouse to visit. Students must also identify two alternative firehouses in case the primary target firehouse cannot be visited. For a student with an accommodation letter who cannot physically visit a local firehouse, there is a virtual option to complete this task.

Virtual option: Students with accessibility limitations should rely on Google Maps, Yelp, a local firehouse's website, or other means such as online reviews, images, and interview people who may have a close connection to the local firehouse chosen.

D1.2 Task Requirements.

1. Identify a local firehouse and two alternates to visit. Provide the name, address, and picture of the primary local firehouse you identified.
2. Describe how and why you selected the primary local firehouse.

[*Click here to go to the Deliverable One Grading Rubrics*](#)

Task D1.3 Reflection (Self-Assessment)

The Reflection task is important because it demonstrates how real learning occurs. Starting with identifying a real local firehouse makes abstract ideas easier to understand because you are learning from something familiar. Studying theory gives you a framework to explain what you observe, rather than leaving concrete experiences as random details. Reflection is important because it helps your experiences into a clear story, addressing what you saw, why it matters, and how it connects to nonprofit business decisions. This structured process makes nonprofit accounting and finance concepts clearer, more meaningful, and easier to apply to real financial decision-making.

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D1.3 Task Requirements:

In one well-developed paragraph, address the following points:

1. How did the data collected from tax returns and other resources that you initially examined give you a framework to understand nonprofit accounting and financial data?
2. How this process strengthened at least three employer-desired competencies (see the discussion on [Employer-Desired Competencies](#) above).

The reflection should clearly demonstrate how the learning sequence helped you understand corporate accounting/finance concepts.

[Click here to go to the Deliverable One Grading Rubrics](#)

Task D1.4: References (Citations) (APA 7th Edition)

References and Citing Work

You may use any authoritative source, including textbooks, academic journals, or professional finance publications. However, you must explicitly cite:

1. Page numbers (books or PDFs), or
2. Deep hyperlinks to exact source locations.
3. Include a list of all sources used, including AI tools and the prompts used, interviews, pricing data, lender websites, insurance providers, academic sources, etc.

The following sources are not acceptable:

1. Wikipedia, Investopedia, or similar aggregator sites.
2. AI-generated explanations without authoritative underlying sources.
3. Note: AI is not considered an authoritative source. It is more akin to a tool to help find authoritative sources.

All work in the project must be cited.

Include a list of all sources used, including AI tools and the prompts used (even though it is not considered authoritative), interviews, pricing data, lender websites, insurance providers, academic sources, etc. Here are some examples:

Narrative Citation (in-text) of a personal interview:

“According to DiLorenzo (April 10, 2025), managing rising equipment costs has forced them to adjust their budgets.”

Parenthetical Citation (in-text) of a personal interview:

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“Managing rising equipment costs has forced them to adjust their budgets (DiLorenzo, M. April 10, 2025).”

Parenthetical Citation (in-text) of using ChatGPT to conduct a personal interview:

“I developed a questionnaire to ask a firehouse personnel questions (ChatGPT, personal communication, June 1, 2025).”

Parenthetical Citation (in-text) of information sourced from a business website:

Protective gear needs to be fire retardant (Fire Equipment Magazine, 2025).

What the **Reference section** will look like, related to the above in-text citations:

DiLorenzo, M. (2025, April 10). *Personal interview*.

OpenAI. (2025, June 1). *ChatGPT response to a prompt about equipment need interviews* [Large language model]. ChatGPT. <https://chat.openai.com/>. **Prompt:** “From the attached document, suggest a set of questions that a nonprofit accounting business student can ask in a interview about equipment needs of a firehouse.”

Fire Equipment Magazine. (2025). *Firehoses*.
<https://www.fireequipmentmagazine.com/products/hoses>

****Important**:** If you require additional information or assistance, please contact your librarian.

Submission Requirements

Name the Excel file D1_Your Last Name_Your First Name

Name the Word file D1_Your Last Name_Your First Name

Upload both files into Brightspace under Deliverable One, according to the syllabus instructions and due date.

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Deliverable Two: Financial Analysis and Firehouse Visitation

Course Learning Outcomes Addressed

CLO 2: Analyze nonprofit financial reporting frameworks to interpret financial position, performance, and transparency.

CLO 4: Evaluate nonprofit financial condition, operational performance, and risk using financial metrics, governance considerations, and internal control concepts.

CLO 6: Demonstrate professional competencies through financial analysis and participation in experiential learning activities.

Deliverable Two Project Learning Outcomes:

1. Integrate employer-desired competencies to develop highly valued employer-desired skills.
2. Construct and analyze a comprehensive financial profile of a nonprofit organization using real-world data and field-based observations.
3. Analyze real nonprofit financial data and interpret nonprofit operations from a nonprofit accounting and financial management perspective.

Deliverable two is intended to allow students to engage in higher-level financial analysis of nonprofit organizations and to immerse themselves in a venue-based, concrete experience. Deliverable two helps connect the abstract theories you are learning in the course materials with active experimentation by researching data on a real-life scenario and evaluating feasibilities.

D2 Tasks:

For this deliverable, students must complete the tasks below. It is important that students become familiar with and follow the D2 grading rubric for each task.

Task D2.1: Review and Analyze Financial Statements

Using the Excel spreadsheet developed in deliverable one, students analyze the financial data and calculate key financial metrics for all available years, such as:

- **Operating Surplus/Deficit:** Total Revenue - Total Expenses
- **Operating Margin:** Operating Surplus / Total Revenue
- **Reserve Ratio:** Cash / Total Expenses
- **Liability Burden:** Liabilities / Total Revenue
- **Donation Dependence:** Donations / Total Revenue

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[*Click here to go back to Deliverable Two Rubrics*](#)

Task D2.2: Firehouse Visitation

In experiential learning, this is considered a venue-based, concrete task. Students conduct a field visit to a local Firehouse. A concrete experience is what you directly observe when you visit the firehouse, such as the fire truck apparatus, protective gear, and communications equipment. The concrete experience is designed to help you understand abstract concepts in your assigned readings.

The purpose of the visit is to engage your external sensory perceptions, such as seeing, hearing, smelling, tasting (if applicable), and experiencing physical sensations such as touch, as well as your internal body's natural awareness of movement, position, effort, balance, fatigue, emotions, all known as kinesthetic proprioception, as you observe a local firehouse in action.

Why is engaging in your senses important for learning?

Learning is deeper and more meaningful when it involves the whole body, not just the eyes and the mind. By paying attention to how work feels, such as the pace of movement, the physical effort required, the tightness of space, and the rhythm of tasks, these senses help you gain insights that cannot be captured by numbers alone. This bodily awareness helps you understand why accounting and finance outcomes appear as they do. Labor costs, productivity, errors, waste, pricing, and staffing decisions are all influenced by the physical realities of work. When you notice strain, repetition, smooth coordination, or congestion, you are observing the real forces that shape costs and revenues.

Engaging your senses and bodily awareness during the visit is intended to set the stage for you to connect abstract financial concepts to real operational experience, thereby helping you transform accounting and financial management from theoretical to practical applications and to understand how a nonprofit business actually functions and generates revenue and incurs expenses.

For those with an accommodation letter who cannot physically visit a local firehouse, there is a virtual option to complete this task. Virtual option: Students with accessibility limitations should rely on Google Maps, Yelp, a local firehouse's website, or other means such as online reviews, images, and interview people who may have a close connection to the local firehouse chosen. You can also work with classmates who may be able to FaceTime their visitation live so you can share the experience. This option has been done successfully in prior coursework as a virtual option.

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Students must visit one local firehouse (either volunteer or government-run) to learn about its basic operations and equipment needs. Firefighters are generally very friendly and love to talk about anything related to firehouses. During the visit, students should attempt to discuss:

- Equipment that needs replacement (e.g., fire trucks, drones, ambulances, etc.)
- Construction or infrastructure needs (e.g., parking lots, firehouse renovations)
- Funding sources (if a volunteer firehouse - donations, grants, etc.)
- Recruitment and training needs

Task D2.3: Reflection

After you have completed your financial analysis and visitation, in two to three paragraphs, describe how your skills and competencies have been strengthened by engaging in Deliverable Two. Specifically, reflect on how you developed a deeper understanding and application in key areas such as financial reasoning, problem-solving, curiosity, adaptability, critical thinking, empathy, emotional intelligence, and written and oral communication. How did it help you grow and develop your ability to engage in nonprofit accounting and financial management analysis and understand the complex operations of a nonprofit organization?

Task D2.4: References (Citations) (APA 7th Edition)

See the [D1.5 References](#). All work in the project must be cited section for specific examples.

Submission Requirements

Name the Excel file D2_Your Last Name_Your First Name

Name the Word file D2_Your Last Name_Your First Name

Upload into Brightspace under Deliverable Two, according to the syllabus instructions and due date.

[*Click here to go back to Deliverable Two Rubrics*](#)

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Deliverable Three: Funding Scenarios Simulation Evaluation

Course Learning Outcomes Addressed

CLO 1: Explain the purpose, legal structure, and distinguishing characteristics of nonprofit organizations and how they differ from for-profit entities.

CLO 2: Analyze nonprofit financial reporting frameworks to interpret financial position, performance, and transparency.

CLO 4: Evaluate nonprofit financial condition, operational performance, and risk using financial metrics, governance considerations, and internal control concepts.

CLO 5: Evaluate and compare alternative funding and financing strategies using scenario-based analysis in a nonprofit context.

CLO 6: Demonstrate professional competencies through financial analysis and participation in experiential learning activities.

Deliverable Three Project Learning Outcomes:

1. Integrate employer-desired competencies to develop highly valued employer-desired skills.
2. Construct and analyze a comprehensive financial profile of a nonprofit organization using real-world data and field-based observations.
3. Analyze real nonprofit financial data and interpret nonprofit operations from a nonprofit accounting and financial management perspective.
4. Defend evidence-based financial recommendations under realistic operational constraints in a nonprofit context.

Tasks:

For this Deliverable Three, students engage in analyzing potential funding requests for a firehouse's needs. Students must complete the tasks below. It is important that students become familiar with and follow the D3 grading rubric for each task.

Task D3.1: Funding Requests

Imagine that you are a consultant hired by the Volunteer Firemen's Association of the City of New York. They have been asked to testify before the New York State legislature to help assess the financial capacity and concerns of volunteer firehouses regarding their ability to sustain operations, given a random sample of a specific need.

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Given what you have learned about the financial data for each fire department, and your limited knowledge about firehouse operations, choose a common piece of equipment, other apparatus, marketing campaign, training courses, or recruitment campaign, and prepare a report for each firehouse expressing your concerns for their funding request.

For each entity, address the following scenario:

1. The fire departments are asking the community to fund it through their membership and small donations.
2. The fire departments are asking for a grant that will be fully funded by the grant maker.
3. The fire departments are asking a bank for a short-term loan to buy the equipment and then be reimbursed by a grant maker.
4. The fire departments are seeking a long-term loan from a bank.

Your concerns should be financial in nature.

Task D3.2: Reflection

Reflect on how you developed a deeper understanding and application in key areas such as financial reasoning, problem-solving, curiosity, adaptability, critical thinking, empathy, emotional intelligence, and written and oral communication. How did it help you grow and develop your ability to model and evaluate capital investment decisions in a real-world business context?

Task D3.3: References (Citations) (APA 7th Edition)

See the [D1.5 References](#). All work in the project must be cited section for specific examples.

Submission Requirements

Name the Word file D3_Your Last Name_Your First Name

Upload into Brightspace under Deliverable Three, according to the syllabus instructions and due date.

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Deliverable Four: Communicating Results

Course Learning Outcomes Addressed

CLOs one through six.

Deliverable Four Project Learning Outcomes:

1. Integrate employer-desired competencies to develop highly valued employer-desired skills.
2. Construct and analyze a comprehensive financial profile of a nonprofit organization using real-world data and field-based observations.
3. Analyze real nonprofit financial data and interpret nonprofit operations from a nonprofit accounting and financial management perspective.
4. Defend evidence-based financial recommendations under realistic operational constraints in a nonprofit context.
5. Communicate financial insights and reflect on experiential learning to demonstrate professional judgment, analytical thinking, and applied competency development.

Deliverable Four challenges students to synthesize and present a nonprofit accounting and financial management story developed over deliverables one, two, and three. This should be presented in a concise, professional PowerPoint. Deliverable four not only reinforces key theories learned during the semester but also deepens the real-world application of financial reasoning in evaluating and advising on nonprofit accounting and financial management issues.

Deliverable four is also designed to cultivate and demonstrate high-demand professional competencies aligned with [Deloitte's Workforce of the Future](#).

This individually graded assignment emphasizes resilience and accountability, requiring students to rehearse, communicate regularly, and produce polished, high-stakes output under a collaborative deadline. By the end of this process, students will have developed a more holistic skill set—blending technical finance expertise with interpersonal, digital communication abilities critical for future business environments.

[Click here to go to the Deliverable Four Grading Rubrics](#)

D4 Tasks:

The D4 grading rubric lists the specific tasks one must complete. During the semester, students are encouraged to draft slides and edit them as they complete deliverables one, two, and three.

How to Make a PowerPoint Slide Show

D4 Requirements:

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1. Draft a storyboard to convey it in a concise presentation, which can simply be a series of empty slides in a PowerPoint that students populate with their ideas. Perhaps a simple and effective demonstration of how to present a storyboard is by Leila Gharani, a prominent YouTuber who specializes in Microsoft product demonstrations. She presents information clearly and concisely. She is not the only person who specializes in this space, but she is well known with several million subscribers. She has produced a video that covers screen recording and recording a slideshow. [How to Easily Make a Video III in PowerPoint \(Slideshow & Screen Recording\)](#). Alternatively, students may want to search the internet for other videos to get ideas on how to use Storyboarding. Students are not bound to use this storyboard demonstration. Students are encouraged to pursue other methods if they are easier or workable.

To assist students in developing a narrated PowerPoint, consider the following video examples:

- How to Record Narration for a PowerPoint Presentation For Dummies: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QZp3jumnWUg>
- Microsoft Office Support: <https://support.office.com/en-us/article/record-a-slide-show-with-narration-and-slide-timings-0b9502c6-5f6c-40ae-b1e7-e47d8741161c>
<https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/office/video-add-and-record-audio-eeac1757-5f20-4379-95f2-0d0cd151d5b8>

2. The whole slideshow presentation should be no longer than five minutes. There is no minimum or maximum amount of slides. Just fall within the time limit. I suggest targeting about 10 slides.

The late policy for deliverable four is the same as for prior deliverables. It is important that students provide their presentations in a timely manner, as it is a near-end-of-semester submission.

[Click here to go to the Deliverable Four Template](#)

[Click here to go to the Deliverable Four Grading Rubrics](#)

Note: I cannot stress enough to students how important it is to rehearse presentations, so mistakes are minimized during the recording and have proper timing. If a student experiences physical challenges speaking clearly, consult the Office of Accommodations for alternatives such as closed captioning.

Last Slide: References (Citations) (APA 7th Edition)

See the [D1.5 References](#). In the last PPT slide, all work in the project must be cited section for specific examples.

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Submission Requirements

Save the file as a PPT. Name the PowerPoint Slide Show file to D4_Your Last Name

Upload the PPT into Brightspace under Deliverable Four, according to the syllabus instructions and due date.

[Click here to go to the Deliverable Four Grading Rubrics](#)

Deliverable Five: Reflection

Course Learning Outcomes Addressed

CLOs one through six.

Deliverable Five Project Learning Outcomes:

1. Integrate employer-desired competencies to develop highly valued employer-desired skills.
2. Construct and analyze a comprehensive financial profile of a nonprofit organization using real-world data and field-based observations.
3. Analyze real nonprofit financial data and interpret nonprofit operations from a nonprofit accounting and financial management perspective.
4. Defend evidence-based financial recommendations under realistic operational constraints in a nonprofit context.
5. Communicate financial insights and reflect on experiential learning to demonstrate professional judgment, analytical thinking, and applied competency development.

Deliverable Five is designed to critically review how the combination of learning nonprofit accounting and financial management concepts from the textbook and the signature term project helps students better learn the course learning objectives.

Deliverable Five Reflections is a two-part process to help develop oral and written presentation competency skills of a comprehensive experiential learning project.

Deliverable Five is solely an individual effort.

D5 Tasks:

For this deliverable, students must complete the tasks below. It is important that students become familiar with and follow the D5 grading rubric for each task.

[Click here to go to the Deliverable Five Grading Rubrics](#)

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Task D5.1: Create an individual reflection about the Project

For **Part One** of Deliverable Five, students combine the reflections from deliverables one through four tell a flowing business story about the events you sensed during the project, including and most importantly, the visit to the firehouse (concrete experiences) and how different theories you studied helped you understand them (abstract conceptualizations), and how everything you did in the Project enhanced all of your [employer-desired competencies](#) detailed in Deliverable One. Did the project strengthen, weaken or it made no difference to them? You need to be very specific in your narrative. You should write passionately and put feeling into it.

The objective of deliverable five is to critically review, in writing, how the combination of learning accounting and finance concepts from the textbook and the signature term project helped students better learn the course learning objectives.

D5.1 Task Requirements:

1. Thinking back on the Concrete Experiences of D1, D2 and D3, give a descriptive reflection of how the firehouse setting engaged you sensory perceptions and why it was important in your learning process.
2. Thinking back on the Abstract Conceptualizations (the theories) in D1, D2 and D3, give a descriptive reflection of how they helped you understand and explain nonprofit accounting and financial management.
3. Thinking back on how your competencies in D1, D2 and D3, give a descriptive reflection of how they were enhanced. Give very specific examples as if you were telling a prospective employer how this project helps develop your employer-desired competencies.

Each student must write up and submit their own work.

[Click here to go to the Deliverable Five Grading Rubrics](#)

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Task D5.2: Create an oral two to three-minute VoiceThread (individual reflection) business story about the Project

For **Part Two** of Deliverable Five, students are to make a three-minute VoiceThread that orally summarizes key learning points for the Signature Term Project in the form of a concise business story. It is akin to a YouTube video short.

Task Requirement:

Imagine that you are asked in a job interview what experience(s) best prepared you to add value to the employer's organization. You are to refer to the Project and describe how you analyzed a real fire department and how it specifically enhanced your employer-desired competences that better enabled you to help make good financial and strategic decisions.

The VoiceThread **cannot exceed** three minutes. You must be concise and impactful.

In this requirement, the instructions are purposeful not to give you an industry for a potential interview. This is one of the exact reasons why this project was designed the way it is. It is for a moment like this that you have to convince an employer how you learned can be applied to all situations. You are placed in a concrete experience, you have to explain it with theory, and further explain how you tested the theory to the situation. This is a foundational skill to develop.

On the VoiceThread, you must rehearse this story over and over to get it right. One day, you may have to really tell this business story to a prospective employer. Tell the story with passion and excitement. Really convince the prospective employer that you are worth it!

Submission Requirements

For Part One is the written narrative: Name the Word file D5_Your Last Name_Your First Name

Part Two is VoiceThread.

Upload the Word Document into Brightspace under Deliverable Five, according to the syllabus instructions and due date. Do not upload a pdf file. **Only Word files will be accepted.**

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Rubrics

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Deliverable One Grading Rubrics

Criteria	Accomplished (100 pts)	Proficient (80 pts)	Developing (60 pts)	Beginning (0 pts)
Task D1.1: Identify all volunteer firehouses in NYC.	Identifies an appropriate firehouse and clearly explains why; describes finance-related observations (equipment, training needs); explains personal engagement in the location; integrates sensory and bodily observations to support understanding of operations and costs.	Identifies an appropriate firehouse; describes basic financial observations and engagement; includes some sensory detail.	Provides a limited explanation of firehouse choice or financial engagement; sensory observations are vague or weakly connected.	Inappropriate firehouse selected or concrete experience not meaningfully described.
Task D1.2: Locate copies of the tax returns filed by the Volunteer Fire Departments.	Locates all available copies of tax returns for six years or all fire departments.	Locates the majority of available copies of tax returns for six years or all fire departments.	Locates less than half of the available copies of tax returns for six years or all fire departments.	Does not locate tax returns.
Task D1.3: Create an Excel spreadsheet of all the names and available years of the entities.	Creates an Excel spreadsheet of all the names and available years of the entities.	Creates an Excel spreadsheet of the majority of names and available years of the entities.	Creates an Excel spreadsheet of less than half of the names and available years of the entities.	Does not create an Excel spreadsheet.

[Click here to go back to Deliverable One Requirements](#)

Criteria	Accomplished (100 pts)	Proficient (80 pts)	Developing (60 pts)	Beginning (0 pts)
Task D1.4: Extract and populate selected financial data.	Extracts and populates all financial data for all available years.	Extracts and populates the majority of the financial data for all available years.	Extracts and populates less than half of the financial data for all available years.	Does not extract and populate financial data.
Task D1.5: Summary description of the financial data collected. Tell the initial financial story about the state of volunteer departments in NYC.	Provides a comprehensive summary description of the financial data collected and tells a concise and coherent initial financial story about the state of volunteer departments in NYC.	Provides a less than comprehensive summary description of the financial data collected or tells a concise or coherent (but not both) initial financial story about the state of volunteer departments in NYC.	Provides a thin summary description of the financial data collected and not a concise and coherent initial financial story about the state of volunteer departments in NYC.	No summary or story.

[Click here to go back to Deliverable One Requirements](#)

Task D1.6: Reflection	Thoughtful and specific reflection; clearly links theories, competency skills, and project experience; demonstrates meaningful personal and professional growth.	Good reflection with some links to theories, competencies and project experience.	Generic reflection with limited insights to theories and competencies; weak connection to learning objectives.	Minimal or absent reflection; lacks personal engagement or depth.
Task D1.7: References (Citations)	All sources cited correctly in APA 7th; includes page numbers or deep URL links; sources are authoritative and clearly integrated; only acceptable sources used. AI-generated citations with clear in-text citations.	Most sources cited correctly; minor APA or formatting errors; some non-acceptable sources used. AI-generated citations with some or unclear in-text citations.	Citations incomplete, inconsistently formatted, or missing required details; non-acceptable sources used. AI-generated citations with little or very unclear in-text citations.	Little or no citation provided or non-acceptable sources used. AI-generated citations with no in-text citations.

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Deliverable Two Grading Rubrics

Criteria	Accomplished (100 pts)	Proficient (80 pts)	Developing (60 pts)	Beginning (0 pts)
Task D2.1: Using the Excel spreadsheet developed in deliverable one, students analyze the financial data and calculate key financial metrics for all available.	Comprehensive analysis (well beyond the suggested ratios in this guide) of the financial data to calculate key financial metrics for all available.	Less than comprehensive analysis (barely beyond the suggested ratios in this guide) of the financial data to calculate key financial metrics for all available.	Thin analysis (just using the suggested ratios in this guide) of the financial data to calculate key financial metrics for all available.	An analysis less than using all the suggested ratios in this guide) of the financial data to calculate key financial metrics for all available.
Task D2.2: Students must visit one local firehouse (either volunteer or government-run) to learn about its basic operations and equipment needs.	Visited at least one local firehouse (either volunteer or government-run) and comprehensively describes (using senses such as sounds, smells, movement, pace, atmosphere) its basic operations and equipment needs, as if the reader were there.	Visited at least one local firehouse (either volunteer or government-run) and less than comprehensively describes (using senses such as sounds, smells, movement, pace, atmosphere) its basic operations and equipment needs, as if the reader were there.	Visited at least one local firehouse (either volunteer or government-run) and thinly describes (using senses such as sounds, smells, movement, pace, atmosphere) its basic operations and equipment needs, as if the reader were there.	Did not visit at least one local firehouse (either volunteer or government-run) or did not describe (using senses such as sounds, smells, movement, pace, atmosphere) its basic operations and equipment needs, as if the reader were there.

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Task D2.3: Reflection	Thoughtful and specific reflection; clearly links theories, competency skills, and project experience; demonstrates meaningful personal and professional growth.	Good reflection with some links to theories, competencies and project experience.	Generic reflection with limited insights to theories and competencies; weak connection to learning objectives.	Minimal or absent reflection; lacks personal engagement or depth.
Task D2.4: References (Citations)	All sources cited correctly in APA 7th; includes page numbers or deep URL links; sources are authoritative and clearly integrated; only acceptable sources used. AI-generated citations with clear in-text citations.	Most sources cited correctly; minor APA or formatting errors; some non-acceptable sources used. AI-generated citations with some or unclear in-text citations.	Citations incomplete, inconsistently formatted, or missing required details; non-acceptable sources used. AI-generated citations with little or very unclear in-text citations.	Little or no citation provided or non-acceptable sources used. AI-generated citations with no in-text citations.

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Deliverable Three Grading Rubrics

Criteria	Accomplished (100 pts)	Proficient (80 pts)	Developing (60 pts)	Beginning (0 pts)
Task D3.1: Funding Requests: The fire departments are asking the community to fund it through their membership and small donations.	Comprehensive analysis of community-based funding, including detailed fundraising targets, realistic participation assumptions, donor segmentation, sustainability considerations, and clear feasibility assessment.	Less than comprehensive analysis, including fundraising targets and basic assumptions about community participation, with some discussion of feasibility.	Basic calculation of fundraising needs using simple assumptions, with limited discussion of feasibility.	Incomplete or unclear analysis; missing key calculations or unrealistic/no assumptions.
Task D3.2: Funding Requests: The fire departments are asking for a grant that will be fully funded by the grant maker.	Comprehensive analysis of full grant funding, including eligibility considerations, likelihood of approval, timing constraints, restrictions, and impact on operations if funding is delayed or denied.	Less than comprehensive analysis of grant funding with general discussion of requirements and timing, but limited depth in risk or constraints.	Basic description of grant funding with minimal analysis of feasibility or constraints.	Little or no analysis of how grant funding works or applies.

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Task D3.3: Funding Requests: The fire departments are asking a bank for a short-term loan to buy the equipment and then be reimbursed by a grant maker.	Comprehensive financial analysis, including accurate loan payment calculations, cash flow timing, bridge financing risk, interest costs, and contingency planning if reimbursement is delayed.	Correct loan calculations with some discussion of timing and repayment, but limited risk analysis.	Basic loan calculation with minimal consideration of timing or reimbursement risk.	Missing or incorrect loan calculations; no understanding of reimbursement structure.
Task D3.4: Funding Requests: The fire departments are seeking a long-term loan from a bank.	Accurate calculations of all three metrics for both financing strategies, the discount rate chosen based on sound theory.	Mostly accurate calculations of all three metrics for both financing strategies with a logical discount rate.	Missing calculations of one of the three metrics for both financing strategies. Lack of logical discount rate, major errors.	Incomplete or incorrect calculations; little understanding of long-term implications.

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Criteria	Accomplished (100 pts)	Proficient (80 pts)	Developing (60 pts)	Beginning (0 pts)
Task D3.5: Reflection	Thoughtful and specific reflection; clearly links theories, competency skills, and project experience; demonstrates meaningful personal and professional growth.	Correct loan calculations with some discussion of long-term impact.	Basic loan calculation with limited interpretation of long-term effects.	Minimal or absent reflection; lacks personal engagement or depth.
Task D3.6: References (APA 7th Ed.)	All sources cited correctly in APA 7th; includes page numbers or deep URL links; sources are authoritative and clearly integrated; only acceptable sources used. AI-generated citations with clear in-text citations.	Most sources cited correctly; minor APA or formatting errors; some non-acceptable sources used. AI-generated citations with some or unclear in-text citations.	Citations incomplete, inconsistently formatted, or missing required details; non-acceptable sources used. AI-generated citations with little or very unclear in-text citations.	Little or no citation provided or non-acceptable sources used. AI-generated citations with no in-text citations.

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Deliverable Four Grading Rubrics

Criteria	Accomplished (100 pts)	Proficient (80 pts)	Developing (60 pts)	Beginning (0 pts)
Task D4.1: Presentation of Deliverable One (Financial Data Gathering and Firehouse Identification)	Clearly integrates two or more specific D1 experiences with two or more relevant nonprofit accounting/finance theories; explanations are accurate, explicit, and decision-oriented, showing how theory informs real financial implications.	Connects at least one D1 experience with at least one relevant theory; explanation is generally correct, but lacks depth, clarity, or strong linkage to financial decision-making.	Mentions experiences or theories but provides unclear, incomplete, or partially incorrect explanations; weak or inconsistent connection between theory and experience.	Fails to meaningfully reference D1 experiences or identify relevant theories; no clear explanation of how theory relates to practice.
Task D4.2: Presentation of Deliverable Two (Financial Analysis and Firehouse Visitation)	Accurately presents two or more quantitative results and provides clear, correct, and decision-focused interpretations demonstrating how results inform financial or operational decisions.	Presents at least one quantitative result with a generally correct interpretation, though explanation may lack depth or include minor errors.	Presents results but explanations are limited, unclear, or partially incorrect; weak connection to decision-making.	Quantitative results are missing, incorrect, or not interpreted, with no connection to decisions.

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Criteria	Accomplished (100 pts)	Proficient (80 pts)	Developing (60 pts)	Beginning (0 pts)
Task D4.3: Presentation of Deliverable Three (Funding Scenarios Simulation Evaluation)	Clearly presents valuation results and provides a logical, accurate, and well-supported explanation linking results to a specific financial recommendation.	Presents at least one valuation metric and attempts to connect it to a recommendation; explanation is generally correct but incomplete.	Mentions valuation results but provides minimal or unclear explanation; connection to decisions is weak or partially incorrect.	Does not meaningfully present or use valuation results; no connection to financial decisions.
Task D4.4: Communicating Results (Integration Across Deliverables)	Effectively integrates multiple accounting/finance theories across D1, D2, and D3, demonstrating clear, accurate, and cohesive application to explain business outcomes.	Applies at least one theory across multiple deliverables with generally correct interpretation, though integration lacks depth or completeness.	Mentions theories but application is inconsistent, superficial, or partially incorrect; weak integration across deliverables.	No meaningful application of theory across deliverables; no integration present.
Task D4.5: Professional Narrative & Timing	Presentation follows a clear, logical, and compelling storyline (experience → analysis → decision); stays within time limit; narration is organized, polished, and easy to follow.	Presentation has a recognizable structure with minor sequencing or clarity issues; narration is understandable but may include pacing or emphasis inconsistencies.	Presentation shows partial or inconsistent organization; narration has noticeable clarity, pacing, or sequencing issues that reduce effectiveness.	Presentation lacks a clear structure; exceeds time limit; narration is unclear, incomplete, or missing, making content difficult to understand.

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Criteria	Accomplished (100 pts)	Proficient (80 pts)	Developing (60 pts)	Beginning (0 pts)
Task D4.6: References	All sources cited correctly in APA 7th; includes page numbers or deep URL links; sources are authoritative and clearly integrated; only acceptable sources used. AI-generated citations with clear in-text citations.	Most sources cited correctly; minor APA or formatting errors; some non-acceptable sources used. AI-generated citations with some or unclear in-text citations.	Citations incomplete, inconsistently formatted, or missing required details; non-acceptable sources used. AI-generated citations with little or very unclear in-text citations.	Little or no citation provided or non-acceptable sources used. AI-generated citations with no in-text citations.

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Deliverable Five Grading Rubrics

Criteria	Accomplished (100 pts)	Proficient (80 pts)	Developing (60 pts)	Beginning (0 pts)
Task D5.1: Written Reflection: Create an individual reflection about the Project	Reflection explicitly explains how learning progressed from D1 → D2 → D3 → D4, and provides specific examples of skill development.	Reflection generally explains the learning progression across deliverables with general examples.	Reflection describes activities completed, but does not clearly explain learning progression.	Reflection is vague, minimal, or missing.
Task D5.2: Written Reflection: Competency Development	Clearly explains growth in all competencies listed in deliverable one, such as critical thinking, adaptability, communication, and financial reasoning; provides specific examples.	Reflects on the development of the majority of competencies with clear, relevant examples.	Mentions some competencies without clear explanation or examples.	No meaningful reflection on competencies; lacks insight or relevance.
Task D5.3: Oral Reflection: Two to three-minute VoiceThread business story about the Project	Synthesizes the full scope of the project (experiences, theories, quantitative analyses, decisions, and reflections) into a convincing, employer-focused business story that clearly demonstrates how the work enhanced multiple employer-desired competencies, communicated with passion and clarity appropriate for a job interview.	Integrates multiple elements of the project to explain how learning developed at least one employer-desired competency, but the business value or persuasive impact is only partially developed.	Describes what was done across the project but focuses on activities or isolated experiences without clearly translating learning into employer-desired competencies or business value.	Summarizes tasks or personal impressions with no meaningful integration of project learning or connection to employer-desired competencies.

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Appendix D - Student Confidentiality Statement

Research Project Confidentiality Form

I hereby pledge to keep confidential, any information about persons, situations, or documents, that I may be privy to during my involvement with the Volunteer Fire Department listed below.

I will not distribute or use any information obtained during this involvement. I will not be paid for any volunteer work encountered in this project.

This project is part of the course work of **[INSERT COURSE NUMBER]**, **[INSERT COURSE NAME]**, at **[INSERT ACADEMIC INSTITUTIONAL NAME]**.

WHEREFORE, I acknowledge that I have read and understand this Agreement and voluntarily accept the duties and obligations set forth herein.

Student Name _____

Name of Business _____

Date _____

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Resources

To be filled in as needed.

References

- Foy, J., et al. 2024. Teaching Financial Accounting and Reporting Through A Venue-Based Experiential Learning Approach. *Accounting Educators' Journal*. 34(1), 1–15, <https://www.aejournal.com/ojs/index.php/aej/article/view/1140>
- Foy, J., et al. 2025. The Terrorism Financing Investigation Case: An Experiential Learning Exercise. *Journal of forensic accounting research*, 1–21, <https://doi.org/10.2308/JFAR-2024-013>
- The Volunteer Firemen’s Association of the City of New York. (2025). *History*. <https://vfanyc.org/about/history/#:~:text=The%20organization%20has%20organized%20events,of%20fire%20and%20other%20emergencies>.

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